

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

After a short honeymoon, they settled back into their work routines.

Karen didn't realize when they got married that Marty came into the marriage with considerable debt from a previous business failure. Later she realized that he had told her he owed some money to friends and family, but she had no idea it was nearly \$50,000. She quickly found out that it took both her salary and his to maintain their budget because so much of Marty's income went to repay debts.

Within a few months she found herself consciously resentful of having to use her money for utilities, food, and car repairs. She felt like she worked two weeks for a paycheck that was gone in one day. One day, in a particularly resentful mood because she couldn't go out to lunch with some of the other women, she told Marty how much she resented it.

Karen couldn't have hurt him more if she had asked him to leave. He was already feeling guilty over his business failure and the fact that he had lost the money his friends and family had entrusted to him.

Marty withdrew from their relationship mentally and emotionally and opened a separate checking account in Karen's name. She apologized for her remarks, but nonetheless deposited her checks in her account and used that money to pay for her personal expenses.

After a few months she noticed that Marty began to let her pay for her own meals when they ate out, which wasn't very often. The guilt began to eat at her and she tried to talk to Marty about helping with the general expenses again. He refused to discuss it and simply said he could make it OK.

A few months later the bank where Karen worked was sold to a large chain and within two weeks she was released. She was totally devastated and found that because of her salary level she was virtually unemployable with any of the other local banks.

In her frustration at home, Karen began to discover that her problem wasn't the job or the money. It was a self-first attitude and God had done the one thing for her that would re-